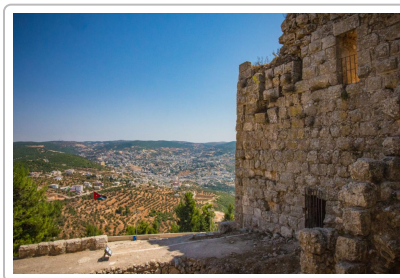
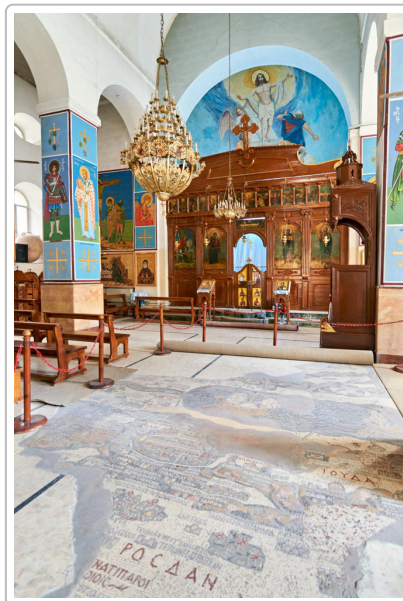


Jordan Travel Guide

Selection and scope

This guide focuses on ten of Jordan's headline attractions that are consistently highlighted by the Jordan Tourism Board's official destination pages and UNESCO-related heritage material: Petra, Wadi Rum, Dead Sea, Jerash, Amman Citadel, Aqaba, Mount Nebo, Madaba, Ajloun Castle, and Dana Biosphere Reserve. Practical details such as fees and opening hours are drawn from official Jordan Tourism Board, Jordan Pass, Holy Land Jordan, Jordan Museums, UNESCO, and Royal Society for the Conservation of Nature sources where available. Because prices and schedules can change, especially around Ramadan and seasonal shifts, I have treated official current pages as the primary source of truth. ¹

Northern and central highlights



Amman Citadel — *Location:* Jabal Al-Qal'a, central Amman. *Short description:* the city's most important hilltop archaeological complex, with the Temple of Hercules, the Umayyad Palace complex, the Byzantine

Church, and commanding views over downtown Amman. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan describes it as the best place to understand the evolution of Amman, and notes that the key monuments on site span Roman, Byzantine, and Umayyad periods. *Main activities:* walking the archaeological plateau, visiting the Jordan Archaeological Museum on the hill, photography, and combining the visit with the Roman Theatre below. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn are the most comfortable seasons in Jordan overall, while early morning or late afternoon is best for softer light and cooler temperatures. *Entry fee:* 3 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* seasonal; the Jordan Pass hours page lists a typical 8:00 AM opening, with closing times varying between about 4:00 PM and 6:30 PM depending on season, and 9:00 AM–5:00 PM during Ramadan. *Travel tips:* pair it with downtown Amman on the same outing, and bring sun protection because there is limited shade on the exposed hilltop. 2

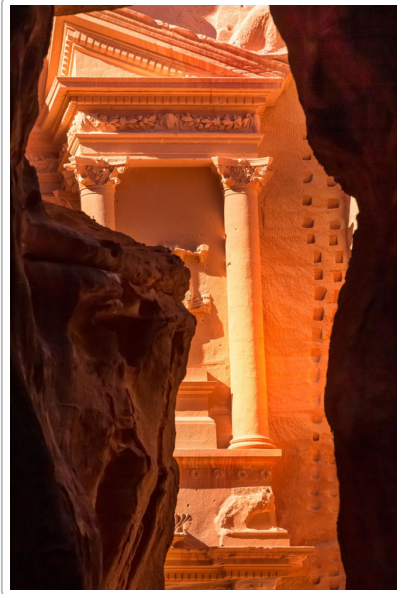
Jerash — *Location:* Jerash city, about 45 km north of Amman. *Short description:* one of the best-preserved Roman provincial cities in the world, famous for its Oval Plaza, colonnaded Cardo Maximus, theatres, temples, and Hadrian's Arch. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan says Jerash has more than 6,500 years of occupation and that its Roman and Graeco-Roman urban fabric remains exceptionally legible; it also preserves evidence of cultural blending between the Mediterranean Roman world and the Arab East. *Main activities:* walking the Cardo, visiting the South Theatre, Oval Plaza, Nymphaeum, and Hadrian's Arch, and timing a trip for the Roman Army and Chariot Experience or the Jerash Festival. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn for the most comfortable weather, or late July to early August if you want the Jerash Festival. *Entry fee:* 10 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* seasonal, typically from 8:00 AM, with closing between roughly 4:00 PM and 6:30 PM depending on season, and 9:00 AM–5:00 PM during Ramadan. *Travel tips:* allow at least half a day, wear good walking shoes on original stone paving, and go early if you want better light and fewer crowds. 3

Madaba — *Location:* Madaba city, southwest of Amman. *Short description:* Jordan's "City of Mosaics," centered on Byzantine and Umayyad mosaic heritage and closely linked to Christian pilgrimage routes. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan describes Madaba as a cultural epicenter for Byzantine and Umayyad mosaics; the city's best-known treasure is the mosaic map in St. George's Church, which official faith-tourism material describes as the oldest illustrated map of Jordan, Palestine, and Egypt. *Main activities:* seeing the Madaba Map in St. George's Church, visiting the Archaeological Park, Church of the Apostles, and nearby mosaic workshops, and using the city as a base for Mount Nebo and the Dead Sea. *Best time to visit:* year-round, but spring and autumn are generally the most comfortable seasons. *Entry fee:* no citywide entry fee; Madaba Archaeological Park and the associated archaeological complex are listed at 3 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* for the Archaeological Park and Church of the Apostles, Jordan Pass lists a typical 8:00 AM opening with seasonal closing between roughly 4:00 PM and 6:30 PM; St. George's Church hours are managed separately and were not clearly published on the official tourism sources reviewed here. *Travel tips:* Madaba works especially well as a half-day stop combined with Mount Nebo, and it is one of the easiest heritage day trips from Amman. 4

Ajloun Castle — *Location:* Ajloun Governorate, in the hills above Ajloun. *Short description:* a major Ayyubid hilltop fortress overlooking the green landscapes of northern Jordan. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan states that the castle, formally Qal'at ar-Rabad, was first built in 1184 by one of Saladin's generals, Izzeddin Usama Mungidh, to repel Crusader threats and protect regional trade routes; it was expanded in 1214. *Main activities:* touring the castle interior and battlements, enjoying the panoramas over olive groves and hills, and combining the visit with Ajloun's forested countryside and nearby Tal Mar Elias. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn are the most comfortable seasons, with spring especially attractive because the surrounding hills are greener. *Entry fee:* 3 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* seasonal, usually from 8:00

AM, with closing between roughly 4:00 PM and 6:30 PM depending on season, and 9:00 AM–5:00 PM during Ramadan. *Travel tips:* combine Ajloun and Jerash in one northern day trip from Amman, and expect cooler weather than the Jordan Valley or the desert. ⁵

Southern and coastal highlights



Petra — *Location:* Wadi Musa, Ma'an Governorate. *Short description:* Jordan's flagship archaeological site, reached through the Siq and famed for Al-Khazneh, the Royal Tombs, the Colonnaded Street, Qasr al-Bint, and the Monastery. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan describes Petra as the Nabataean legacy and one of Jordan's national treasures; UNESCO calls it one of the world's richest and largest archaeological sites in a red sandstone landscape, with a remarkable ancient water-management system. *Main activities:* walking the main Siq-to-Treasury trail, continuing deeper into the city, taking side hikes such as Al-Khubtha and Ad-Deir, and visiting Petra Museum or the evening Petra by Night experience. *Best time to visit:* March to May or September to early November, when conditions are typically milder than midsummer. *Entry fee:* 50 JOD for a standard one-day foreign visitor ticket, 55 JOD for two days, 60 JOD for three days, and 90 JOD for one-day visitors to Jordan; Petra is also covered by the Jordan Pass. *Opening hours:* seasonal; Jordan Pass lists 6:00 AM opening with closing between about 4:00 PM and 6:00 PM depending on season, and 6:30 AM–5:30 PM during Ramadan. *Travel tips:* start early, wear proper walking shoes, carry water, stay on marked trails, and use registered guides if you want context or plan to tackle higher routes. ⁶

Wadi Rum — *Location:* Wadi Rum Protected Area, southern Jordan, near Wadi Rum village and the Saudi border. *Short description:* the “Valley of the Moon,” a vast desert of sandstone massifs, canyons, arches, dunes, and Bedouin camps. *Historical and cultural importance:* UNESCO classifies Wadi Rum as a mixed natural and cultural World Heritage site and notes its petroglyphs, inscriptions, archaeological remains, and 12,000 years of human occupation; Visit Jordan also frames it as a living Bedouin landscape. *Main activities:* 4x4 tours, stargazing, camel rides, hot-air balloon flights, camp stays, horse riding, and longer treks through desert scenery. *Best time to visit:* March to May and September to early November; summer can be intensely hot and winter nights can be cold. *Entry fee:* 5 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* Jordan Pass lists Wadi Rum as open 24 hours. *Travel tips:* only head into the desert with organized local operators or licensed guides, especially if you are not staying in a camp, and pack layers because day and night temperatures can differ sharply. 7

Dead Sea — *Location:* Jordan's Dead Sea coast, roughly an hour southwest of Amman. *Short description:* the lowest point on Earth and Jordan's best-known wellness destination, combining mineral-rich waters, therapeutic mud, resorts, public waterfront areas, and nearby museum stops. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan identifies it as a major natural wonder located about 427 meters below sea level and notes that its buoyant, mineral-rich waters have attracted visitors since antiquity. *Main activities:* floating in the water, using Dead Sea mud, enjoying resort spas, walking the Corniche and Promenade, and visiting the Lowest Point Museum. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn are generally the most comfortable; October and November are highlighted by Visit Jordan as a high season for some Dead Sea-area activities, while summer midday heat can be intense. *Entry fee:* there is no single official area-wide entry fee because access depends on resort day passes or public-beach arrangements; the Lowest Point Museum is listed at 2 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* no single area-wide schedule is published in the official sources reviewed here because beach and resort access varies by operator. *Travel tips:* keep both mud and water away from your eyes and mouth, and rinse off after floating. 8

Aqaba — *Location:* Aqaba city on Jordan's southern Red Sea coast. *Short description:* Jordan's only coastal city, combining beaches, diving, coral reefs, Mamluk-era heritage, and a relaxed resort atmosphere. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan highlights Aqaba Castle's Mamluk and Ottoman layers and notes the city's long maritime and military significance; the destination is also central to Jordan's Red Sea tourism economy. *Main activities:* scuba diving, snorkeling, boat trips, visiting Aqaba Castle, seeing the Sharif Hussein bin Ali Mosque, and beach time. *Best time to visit:* Aqaba works year-round, and Visit Jordan materials note that diving and snorkeling are excellent at any time of year; in summer, plan active sightseeing early in the morning or near sunset. *Entry fee:* no citywide fee; heritage entry such as Aqaba Castle/Hamima/Sharif Hussein bin Ali Mosque is listed at 3 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* city beaches and private operators vary, but Jordan Pass lists the Aqaba Museum/Sharif Hussein House schedule as a typical 8:00 AM opening with seasonal closing between about 4:00 PM and 6:30 PM, and 9:00 AM–5:00 PM in Ramadan. *Travel tips:* use licensed dive centers, and if you are adding Aqaba to a classic Jordan route, it pairs naturally with Petra and Wadi Rum. 9

Sacred and eco landscapes



Mount Nebo — *Location:* west of Madaba, overlooking the Jordan Valley. *Short description:* a major biblical and pilgrimage site associated with Moses, with a memorial church, monastery remains, mosaics, and sweeping viewpoints. *Historical and cultural importance:* Visit Jordan and Holy Land Jordan identify Mount Nebo as the place from which Moses viewed the Holy Land; official faith-tourism material also notes the mosaics and church-monastery heritage on the site. *Main activities:* visiting the Moses Memorial Church, viewing mosaics, seeing the famous Serpentine Cross outside the sanctuary, and taking in panoramic views over the Jordan Valley and Dead Sea. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn, when visibility is usually good and midday heat is easier to manage. *Entry fee:* 3 JOD for foreign visitors. *Opening hours:* I did not find a clearly current official public-hours page for Mount Nebo itself in the tourism sources reviewed here, so it is wise to confirm locally before making a tight itinerary. *Travel tips:* Mount Nebo is best paired with Madaba, and modest dress is sensible because it remains an active religious site. ¹⁰



Dana Biosphere Reserve — *Location:* Dana and Feynan area, south-central Jordan. *Short description:* Jordan's largest biosphere reserve, known for deep wadis, escarpments, desert-and-mountain transitions, wildlife, eco-lodges, and serious hiking. *Historical and cultural importance:* the Royal Society for the Conservation of Nature says Dana was established in 1989 and is Jordan's largest and first biosphere reserve; Visit Jordan highlights both its ecological diversity and the archaeological remains around Feynan, including ancient copper-mining landscapes. *Main activities:* hiking trails such as Rummana, White Dome, and Wadi Ghweir, birdwatching, stargazing, mountain biking, village visits, and guided experiences around Feynan Ec lodge and the old copper mines. *Best time to visit:* spring and autumn are the classic seasons; on official pages, some signature trails such as Rummana and White Dome operate from March 15 to October 31, while others run year-round with licensed guides. *Entry fee:* Visit Jordan lists 10 JOD for foreign visitors for the reserve, while official RSCN rate sheets also publish tax-inclusive and trail-specific pricing, so confirm the exact product before you book. *Opening hours:* no single daily public-hours schedule was clearly published; access is largely organized by trail availability and guide bookings. *Travel tips:* plan ahead if you want the longer canyon routes, because many of them are guide-only and some have seasonal or age restrictions. ¹¹

Planning notes

For most international visitors doing a multi-stop Jordan itinerary, the **Jordan Pass** is usually the best-value practical tool. Official pricing is 70 JOD for the Jordan Wanderer, 75 JOD for the Jordan Explorer, and 80 JOD for the Jordan Expert, and the pass includes Petra plus entry to more than 40 attractions; it can also waive the tourist visa fee if bought before arrival and used under the stated stay conditions. The official visa-on-arrival fee at many border points is 40 JOD for a single entry, which is why the pass often pays for itself quickly on a Petra-centered trip. ¹²

A few practical patterns make Jordan travel easier. A classic first-time route is **Amman → Jerash/Ajloun → Madaba/Mount Nebo → Dead Sea → Petra → Wadi Rum → Aqaba**, with Petra and Wadi Rum best treated as early-start destinations because of terrain and heat. Petra and Wadi Rum are also easy to combine

logistically: Visit Jordan's current routing guide says the drive between them is typically about 1.5 to 2 hours.

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The most important caution is that **official hours and seasonal access do move**. Petra, the Citadel, Jerash, Ajloun Castle, Madaba archaeological sites, and Aqaba museum sites all use seasonal schedules, and Dana trail access depends on trail and guide availability. If your trip is tightly timed, recheck the official Jordan Pass hours page or the relevant site page shortly before travel. 14

1 Where to Go in Jordan | Top Attractions & Destinations

https://international.visitjordan.com/where-to-go/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

2 Amman Jordan 2026 – Citadel, Rainbow Street & Local Culture

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/amman/>

3 Jerash Jordan 2026 – Roman Ruins, RACE Show & Jerash Festival

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/jerash/>

4 Madaba Jordan 2026 – Mosaics, St. George Church & Ma'in Springs

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/madaba/>

5 Ajloun, Jordan | Forests, Nature & Islamic Castle

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/ajloun/>

6 Petra, Jordan | Trails, Petra by Night & UNESCO Wonder

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/petra/>

7 Wadi Rum Jordan 2026 – Stargazing, 4X4 Tours & Bedouin Life

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/wadi-rum/>

8 Dead Sea Jordan 2026

https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/the-dead-sea/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

9 Aqaba, Jordan | Beaches, Diving & Red Sea Escape

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/aqaba/>

10 Mount Nebo, Jordan | Moses Memorial & Holy Views

<https://international.visitjordan.com/wheretogo/mount-nebo/>

11 Dana Biosphere Reserve

https://www.rscn.org.jo/reserve/list?lang=en&utm_source=chatgpt.com

12 Packages

https://www.jordanpass.jo/Contents/Prices.aspx?utm_source=chatgpt.com

13 Petra Jordan How to Get There

https://international.visitjordan.com/blog/26/petra-jordan-how-to-get-there/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

14 Opening Hours

https://www.jordanpass.jo/contents/Opening_Hours.aspx